

10 out of 10 life upgrades for men that cost \$100 or less

Channel: Brandon Carter · Published: Aug 31, 2026 · Watch: <https://www.youtube.com/shorts/pVlwANzeLdo> Source: full transcript

Executive Summary

Brandon Carter runs through 10 practical, low-cost purchases — a food scale, walking shoes, creatine, a big water bottle, blackout curtains, and more — that he argues will meaningfully upgrade a man's health, productivity, and lifestyle.

Contents

-  Upgrade 1: Food Scale
-  Upgrade 2: Good Walking Shoes
-  Upgrade 3: Meal Prep Delivery Service
-  Upgrade 4: Creatine Monohydrate
-  Upgrade 5: Huge Water Bottle
-  Upgrade 6: Blackout Curtains
-  Upgrade 7: Cheap Notebook
-  Upgrade 8: ChatGPT Pro Subscription
-  Upgrade 9: Pack of Fitted Black T-Shirts
-  Upgrade 10: Fitbit (Budget Fitness Tracker)

Upgrade 1: Food Scale [0:00](#)

- Purpose: track your macros accurately
 - The explicit goal is to "finally stop being a fat boy" — implying most men underestimate portion sizes without one

Upgrade 2: Good Walking Shoes [0:00](#)

- Purpose: enable consistent daily walking
 - Target step count: **10,000–20,000 steps per day**
 - Comfortable, supportive footwear is framed as the key barrier to hitting that range

Upgrade 3: Meal Prep Delivery Service [0:00](#)

- Delivers healthy food to you every week
- Acknowledged exception: this upgrade costs **more than \$100**
 - Justification for the higher spend:
 - Saves money otherwise spent on groceries
 - Saves time otherwise spent traveling to the store
 - Eliminates time spent cooking and doing dishes
 - Net result: "you'll end up saving way more than you spend"

Upgrade 4: Creatine Monohydrate 0:22

- Recommended for **everyone**, even people who don't work out
 - Benefits cited: brain health and mental health, not just physical performance
 - Suggested dosage cadence: daily

Upgrade 5: Huge Water Bottle 0:22

- Purpose: remove the mental overhead of tracking water intake
 - A large-capacity bottle lets you hit **over 1 gallon per day** passively
 - Brandon's personal intake: **2 gallons per day**

Upgrade 6: Blackout Curtains 0:44

- Purpose: improve sleep quality by blocking outside light
 - Rationale: "you're not going to be out here hustling and grinding if you're tired"
 - Framed as a foundational productivity tool, not just a comfort item

Upgrade 7: Cheap Notebook 0:44

- Keep one on you at all times
 - Use cases: capturing ideas and logging everything you need to remember
 - Emphasis on it being "cheap" — the habit matters, not the price of the item

Upgrade 8: ChatGPT Pro Subscription 0:44

- Use it to "automate all the grunt work in your life"
 - Primary benefit: saving time by offloading low-value, repetitive cognitive tasks
 - Positioned as a leverage tool for productivity

Upgrade 9: Pack of Fitted Black T-Shirts 0:44

- Specific recommendation: **fitted, V-neck variety**, black color

- Simplifies daily outfit decisions while maintaining a clean, put-together look



Upgrade 10: Fitbit (Budget Fitness Tracker) 1:06

- Referred to as "Fitbit Air" in the transcript
- Tracks: **calories burned** and **sleep data**
- Positioned as the best option for those who can't afford premium wearables
 - Named premium alternatives: **Whoop** and **Oura Ring**
 - Price ceiling cited: **\$400 or less**

The throughline across all 10 upgrades: remove friction from healthy habits (eating, moving, sleeping, thinking) so discipline becomes the default, not a daily battle.